

Surems are solidly built and rarely more than five feet in height. They have broad, pleasant faces and usually maintain a serene expression. They dress following the custom of the Yaqui.

Affinity: Actor

BIRTHRIGHTS

Serenity — Surems can project a powerful air of serenity around them. When actively exerting this calming influence, anyone within range must make a Willpower roll (difficulty 8) to speak angry words or take any violent action.

Congeniality — Surems receive an extra success on all Charisma rolls, provided the initial roll is not a failure. Also, they cannot botch any Empathy or Leadership roll.

FRAILTIES

Plowshares: Commitment to pacifism and peaceful resolutions is so ingrained that if a surem resorts to violence, or even speaks harshly, she suffers a Banality trigger. All violent actions are made at +1 difficulty.

"Come, my friends. Let us sit together and smoke. Be calm."

Tunghat

These goblin-like Nunnehi are known to the tribes of the plains, plateau, and basin regions as the masters of animals. They were messengers between human and animalkind, and ceremonies would be performed before a hunt to warn the tunghat so they could select the animals that most needed to be culled, and choose which were to be sacrificed so that their human "cousins" may live. Today, ceremonies such as this are rare, but the tunghat still watch over the animals, punish hunters who are disrespectful or wasteful, and sometimes aid those who are honor the old ways. Tunghat have become increasingly embittered by the failure of most tribes and hunters to acknowledge their roles in the life cycle. Some among the tunghat have begun to urge the entire tribe to arise and lead their animal charges on assaults against encroaching towns and businesses. However, others seek to work with the tribes, encouraging them to become more active in the protection of animals.

Similar to the pooka, all tunghat share a special kinship with a particular type of animal. Each tunghat undergoes a special ceremony, after which the first wild animal he sees is the one he is bonded with. Common animals include deer, rabbits, pronghorns, coyotes, birds, foxes, and bears.

Traditionally, tunghat lived in woven grass tipis in the territory frequented by their chosen animal companion. However, in recent times tunghat can be found living in cabins or trailers in wilderness areas and sometimes, though rarely, even in towns or cities. They are a gregarious people, and a number of those who have the same animal companion can often be found living in tight-knit communities; in areas where wildlife is abundant, several different types can be found living together.

Tunghat are small of build and have green skin with even darker green hair, nails, and teeth. They have large, wide mouths with sharp teeth and a somewhat "goblinish" appear-

ance. They dress in green and wear woven grass ponchos that they sometimes use for shelter or to hide.

Affinity: Nature

BIRTHRIGHTS

Animal Illusion — The tunghat can create an illusion that causes him to be perceived as the animal with which he is bonded. The illusion is always a little bit flawed; the markings may be wrong, color slightly off, or it might be too large or too small.

A tunghat can use this power at will. Penetrating the illusion requires a Perception + Alertness (for mortals) or Kenning (for changelings) roll at difficulty 8. A single success means the observer notices that something is off about the illusion. Two more successes allows complete penetration of the illusion.

Summon Herd — A tunghat must choose a particular animal with which she has a special bond. She may summon animals of this kind who are within a half day's travel. She may then appeal to them to aid her, even asking the old or infirm to sacrifice themselves on her behalf.

The animals always respond to the summons, but the player must succeed in a Manipulation + Empathy roll (difficulty 7) for the tunghat to convince the animals to serve her. The Storyteller sets the number of successes needed based on the nature of the task. One success for the animal to deliver a message or five successes to sacrifice itself on the tunghat's behalf.

FRAILTIES

Animal Mind — The longer a tunghat maintains her Animal Illusion, the greater the chance she may lose herself in the illusion, coming to believe she is her bonded animal.

For every hour past the first that she maintains the illusion, the player must roll Willpower (difficulty 7). Failure means she becomes locked into the illusion, and begins to act like a normal member of the species. For every hour after, she can attempt another test. A botch indicates that she is locked into the form and can only escape with outside help.

"We are still the caretakers of our animal brothers and sisters... but we, like them, have been forgotten as humans seek progress."

Water babies

Best known by the Shoshone, Washoe, Nez Percés, and the Northern Paiute, water babies have a fearsome reputation for kidnapping children and drowning victims who venture near their waters. Believed by most to be man tribespeople and are often fully judges of those who harm children and protectors of the water.

Water babies do not tolerate those who harm children, and they act quickly to remove any children they deem to be suffering, neglected, or abused. They take these children into their homes, hidden away from mortal eyes, and raise them as their own. They are also quick to exact vengeance on any who dare pollute or despoil the waters, dragging them below the surface to meet a watery doom.